

HONOR IN CAMP CRAFT

By Misheck Mwanza (Mishcool)

WHAT IS CAMPING?

Camping is the indoor or outdoor living away from home for a short period of time, usually for learning, recreation, training, or fellowship. It involves using temporary shelters and basic equipment to meet daily needs such as sleeping, cooking, and hygiene.

IMPORTANCE OF CAMPING (ADVENTIST PERSPECTIVE)

Camping is encouraged in

Promotes physical fitness and healthful living

Builds character and self-discipline

Encourages teamwork and cooperation

Teaches practical survival skills

Develops leadership and responsibility

Helps campers appreciate nature as God's creation

CAMP CRAFT

Camp craft refers to the skills and knowledge required to live comfortably, safely, and responsibly in a camp environment. It includes setting up camp, using tools correctly, cooking outdoors, maintaining cleanliness, and observing safety rules.

Honor in camp craft emphasizes order, safety, care of equipment, respect for others, and care for the environment.

THE SIX WS OF CHOOSING A CAMPSITE

When choosing a campsite, campers use the Six Ws, which help ensure the site is safe, comfortable, and suitable for camping.

1. WEATHER

Consider the weather conditions of the area.

The campsite should be in a place with favorable and predictable weather.

Avoid areas known for heavy rain, strong storms, or extreme temperatures.

2. WATER

There should be a reliable and clean water source nearby for drinking, cooking, and washing.

The campsite should be far enough from rivers or lakes to prevent flooding.

3. WIND

The site should be protected from strong winds.

Natural windbreaks such as trees, bushes, or hills are important.

4. WELL-DRAINED AREA

Choose a campsite on slightly raised ground.

Avoid valleys and low-lying areas where water collects during rain.

5. WILLINGNESS

Willingness means that a camper must be ready and willing to go to camp.

A camper should have a positive attitude, obedience, and readiness to follow camp rules.

Willingness is the most important factor, because without willingness, camping cannot be successful.

The campsite should be in a place where permission has been granted by the land owner or authority.

Campers should be welcome to use the area.

6. WOOD

There should be enough dry wood available for cooking and warmth.

Firewood should be collected responsibly without damaging the environment.

CAMPING OFFICERS

Camping officers are leaders appointed to manage, supervise, and ensure smooth running of camp activities. Each officer has specific duties to promote order, safety, and success of the camp.

1. CAMP MASTER

The top leader of the camp

Overall head and controller of the camp

Plans, directs, and supervises all camp activities

Ensures discipline, safety, and smooth running of the camp

Coordinates and oversees all camping officers

2. DEPUTY CAMP LEADER

Assists the camp leader

Acts in the absence of the camp leader

Supervises specific camp duties as assigned

3. QUARTERMASTER

In charge of camping equipment and tools

Issues and receives camping gear

Ensures proper care and storage of equipment

4. COOK / CATERING OFFICER

Responsible for food preparation

Ensures meals are cooked on time

Maintains cleanliness in the kitchen area

5. HEALTH AND SAFETY OFFICER

In charge of first aid

Ensures camp safety rules are followed

Handles emergencies and health issues

6. HYGIENE AND SANITATION OFFICER

Ensures cleanliness of the camp

Supervises waste disposal and toilets

Promotes good personal hygiene

7. PROGRAM OFFICER

Organizes daily camp programs and activities

Coordinates games, worship, and training sessions

8. SECURITY OFFICER

Ensures safety of campers and property

Controls movement in and out of the camp

CAMPING GEARS

Camping gears are the equipment and tools used during camping to ensure comfort, safety, and efficiency. They are grouped into the following main categories:

1. SLEEPING GEAR

Sleeping gear provides rest and comfort during camping.

Tent

Sleeping bag or blanket

Sleeping mat or mattress

Ground sheet or tarpaulin

2. COOKING GEAR

Cooking gear is used to prepare and serve food in camp.

Cooking stove or firewood

Matches or lighter

Pots and pans

Plates, cups, and cutlery

Water containers

3. MISCELLANEOUS GEAR

These are additional items that support camp activities and safety.

Torch or flashlight

Rope

Knife or multi-tool

First aid kit

Whistle

Backpack

Soap and cleaning materials

4. BATHROOM (TOILETRY) GEAR

Bathroom gear is used for personal hygiene and cleanliness during camp.

Toothbrush and toothpaste

Bathing soap

Towel

Toilet paper

Bucket or bathing container

Comb or hair brush

Sanitary items (where necessary)

CARE AND USE OF CAMPING GEARS

Use equipment only for its intended purpose

Clean and dry equipment after use

Store gear properly

Avoid waste and misuse

Share equipment responsibly

Proper care of camping gear reflects discipline and honor in camp craft.

CAMP RULES AND DISCIPLINE (ADVENTIST GUIDELINES)

Obey camp leaders and instructors

Observe safety rules at all times

Keep the camp clean

Respect nature and wildlife

Work cooperatively with others

CONCLUSION

Camping and camp craft are important activities that promote physical, mental, and moral development. Through proper camping practices and correct use of camping gear, individuals learn responsibility, cooperation, and respect for nature. In the

REVIEW QUESTIONS

1. Define camping.
2. Explain camping from an
3. What is camp craft?
4. List four types of camping gear.
5. State the importance of camping.
6. Why is care of camping gear important?
7. Mention three rules to be observed during camping.

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